HHH-V-1867/3A

January 10, 1975
SUPERSEDING
HHH-V-1867/3
July 10, 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION SHEET

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LETTUCE, FRESH, READY-TO-USE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

The complete requirements for procuring the fresh, ready-to-use lettuce described herein shall consist of this document and the latest issue of specification HHH-V-1867/GEN.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers specific requirements for fresh, ready-to-use head lettuce.

1.2 Classification. The lettuce shall be the following types and styles, as specified.

1.2.1 Types.

Iceberg
Boston
Bibb
Similar types

1.2.2 Styles.

I - Whole head, cored
II - Chopped, coarse
III - Chopped, medium
IV - Shredded

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS - In accordance with Federal Specification HHH-V-1867/GEN and documents referenced therein.

3. REQUIREMENTS - In accordance with HHH-V-1867/GEN, documents referenced therein and as follows:

FSC 8915

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3.1 General. The lettuce prior to preparation shall meet the requirements of US No. 1 grade or better in accordance with the US Standards for Grades of Lettuce. The lettuce used shall be closely trimmed lettuce from which the cores have been removed in accordance with good commercial practice. The prepared lettuce shall be free from defects which materially detract from its appearance or edibility and shall not be prepared more than 24 hours prior to the required delivery time. The prepared lettuce may be treated with sulfur dioxide or other means permissable under the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 Styles.

3.2.1 Whole head, cored. This style shall consist of cored lettuce with the heads intact.

3.2.2 Chopped, coarse. Coarse chopped lettuce shall consist of 1-inch minimum to 3 inches maximum cut pieces, unless a size within that range is specified (see 6.1).

3.2.3 Chopped, medium. Medium chopped lettuce shall consist of 1/4 - to 1-inch cut pieces, unless a specific size within that range is specified (see 6.1).

3.2.4 Shredded. Shredded lettuce shall consist of shreds 1/8 to 1/4 inch in width.

3.3 Storage. The prepared lettuce has very limited shelf life and shall be kept under refrigeration to maintain quality. Temperatures of 32° - 35° F (0° - 1.7°C) are recommended.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS - In accordance with HHH-V-1867/GEN, documents referenced therein and as follows:

4.1 Lettuce. Conformance of closely trimmed lettuce (prior to further processing) to grade requirements shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent markings or grade certificate. Use of lettuce lower than US No. 1 in quality shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.2 Examination of end item. Examinations shall be in accordance with table II and 4.2.1. Sampling plans for the table of examination shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for table II.

TABLE I. Sampling plans

Tables	Sample unit	Lot-size expressed in	Inspection level	AQLs Major
II	1 head of style I or 1 pound of style II, III, or IV from a bag	Bags	S-2	1.0

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TABLE II. Examination of product 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Core not removed from style I lettuce or pieces of core in style II, III or IV lettuce.
102	Head of style I lettuce not intact.
103	Defects which materially affect appearance or eating quality.
104	More than 10 percent by count of style II, III or IV product not as required. 2/

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g., metal, wood, filth, glass, insects, paint, etc.) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Examine 16 ounces of style II, 2-ounces of style III and 1-ounce of style IV per sample unit.

4.2.1 Age of product. Product shall not be acceptable if prepared more than 24 hours prior to delivery schedule. Records shall be maintained indicating preparation period.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY - In accordance with Federal Specification HHH-V-1867/GEN, documents referenced therein except as follows:

5.1 Packaging, level C. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), 10 or 20 pounds of style I lettuce, 10 pounds of style II lettuce, or 5 pounds of style III or IV lettuce shall be packaged in a polyethylene bag which is clean, sound and securely sealed to provide adequate protection of the lettuce from dirt, filth or other contamination. Each bag shall be well filled, but contents shall not show excessive or unnecessary bruising because of overfill.

5.2 Packing, level C. Not more than 40 pounds of any one style shall be packed in a shipping container in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

6. NOTES - In accordance with HHH-V-1867/GEN, documents referenced therein and as follows:

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) When ~~specific~~ size is required (see 3.2.2 or 3.2.3).
(b) Amount of style I lettuce in a package (see 5.1).
(c) When amounts other than specified for styles II, III or IV are required (see 5.1).

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